

Lucas Wright

Doctoral Candidate, Department of Communication, Cornell University

Ithaca, NY 14850

law323@cornell.edu

lucaswright.net

EDUCATION

- 2026 (expected)** Ph.D., Communication, Cornell University
Committee: J. Nathan Matias, Brooke Duffy, Tarleton Gillespie, Natalie Stroud
- 2023** MS, Communication, Cornell University
- 2018** MSc, Social Science of the Internet, University of Oxford
- 2016** BA, Political Science, American University

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- Wright, L.**, Matias, J. N., Penney, J., Mou, M. E., & Klein, M. (n.d.). Do automated copyright removals reduce expression online? a quasi-experimental study of chilling effects on twitter. *Nature Human Behaviour*
Stage One Registered Report Accepted In Principle.
- Wright, L.** (2025). The salesforce of safety: Software vendors as infrastructural/professional nodes in the field of online trust and safety. *Platforms & Society*, 2, 29768624251390683. <https://doi.org/10.1177/29768624251390683>
- Wright, L.**, Muenster, R. M., Vecchione, B., Qu, T., Cai, P., Smith, A., Investigators, C. 2. S., Metcalf, J., & Matias, J. N. (2024). *Null compliance: NYC local law 144 and the challenges of algorithm accountability*. <https://dl.acm.org/doi/pdf/10.1145/3630106.3658998>
- Wright, L.** (2022). Automated platform governance through visibility and scale: On the transformational power of automoderator. *Social Media+ Society*, 8(1), 20563051221077020. <https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/full/10.1177/20563051221077020>
- Wright, L.**, Ruths, D., Dillon, K. P., Saleem, H. M., & Benesch, S. (2017). Vectors for counterspeech on twitter. *Proceedings of the first workshop on abusive language online*, 57–62. <https://aclanthology.org/W17-3009.pdf>

BOOK CHAPTERS

- Wright, L.** (2025). Trust and safety vendors: Looking back and forward. In M. L. Daniel, A. Menking, M. T. Savio, & J. Claffey (Eds.), *Trust, safety, and the internet we share: Multistakeholder insights*. Taylor & Francis. <https://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5360109>

UNDER REVIEW

- Wright, L.** (n.d.). Selling security: How counter-disinformation discourse enables commercial markets for speech monitoring.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

- Foster, M. E., Wardle, C., & **Wright, L.** (n.d.). Synthetic researcher dialogs: How LLMs are transforming the role of the researcher in qualitative interview methodologies.

- Wright, L.** & Griffin, R. (n.d.). Professionalization of trust and safety and the construction of risk and security in industry practice
Invited to submit to special issue of Internet Policy Review.
- Wright, L.** & Matias, J. N. (n.d.). Improving engagement with online communities after a temporary ban through value self-affirmations.

SCHOLARLY REPORTS

- Constanza, M. V. B., Candela, J. Q., **Wright, L.**, Bogan, L., & Faddoul, M. (2022). *Technology primer: Social media recommendation algorithms*. Edited by Ariel Higuchi, Amritha Jayanti. Belfer Center for Science, and International Affairs, Harvard Kennedy School. <https://www.belfercenter.org/publication/technology-primer-social-media-recommendation-algorithms>
- Matias, J. N., & **Wright, L.** (2022). Impact assessment of human-algorithm feedback loops. *Social Science Research Council*. <https://just-tech.ssrc.org/field-reviews/impact-assessment-of-human-algorithm-feedback-loops/>

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Foster, M. E., Wardle, C., & **Wright, L.** (2026). *Synthetic researcher dialogs: How LLMs are transforming the role of the researcher in qualitative interview methodologies* [International Communication Association]
Paper presented at the International Communication Association, Cape Town, South Africa.
- Grover, R., Waldman, A. E., **Wright, L.**, Elettra, B., & Citron, D. (2026). *The political economy of technocratic authority in digital governance*
Panel Presented at the Association of Law and Political Economy Conference, Richmond, VA, USA.
- Wright, L.** (2025a). *The political economy of trust and safety vendors*
Paper presented at the International Communication Association, Denver, USA.
- Wright, L.** (2025b). *Securitization of information: The universal and objective discourse of cognitive security threats*
Paper presented at the International Communication Association, Denver, USA.
- Wright, L.** (2024). *The political economy of trust and safety vendors*
Paper presented at the Association of Internet Researchers Conference, Sheffield, England.
- Wright, L.**, Muenster, R. M., Vecchione, B., Qu, T., Cai, P., Smith, A., Investigators, C. 2. S., Metcalf, J., & Matias, J. N. (2024). *Null compliance: NYC local law 144 and the challenges of algorithm accountability*. <https://dl.acm.org/doi/pdf/10.1145/3630106.3658998>
- Matias, J. N., & **Wright, L.** (2022). *Impact assessment of human-algorithm feedback loops*.
Conference on Digital Experimentation @ MIT, Virtual.
- Wright, L.** (2022). *Content moderation as spectacle*
Work in progress presented at the International Communication Association, Paris, France.
- Wright, L.**, Matias, J. N., Mou, M. E., Penney, J., & Klein, M. (2021). *Do automated legal threats reduce freedom of expression online? preliminary results from a natural experiment*
Paper presented at the International Communication Association, Virtual.
- Wright, L.** (2019). *Governing with the AutoModerator bot: A mixed methods study of algorithmic moderation on reddit* [Paper presented at the ICA Rise of Platforms Post Conference, Washington, DC.]
Paper presented at the ICA Rise of Platforms Post Conference, Washington, DC.

INVITED TALKS

- Wright, L.** (2025, December 3). *The salesforce of safety: Software vendors as infrastructural/professional nodes in online trust and safety* [Platform Politics and Policy Seminar Series]. <https://www.wzb.eu/en/events/the-salesforce-of-safety-software-vendors-as-infrastructural-professional-nodes-in-online-trust-and>

Wright, L. (2024, November 5). *The political economy of trust and safety vendors* [Ada Lovelace Brown Bag Series].

POLICY REPORTS

Matias, J. N., Penney, J., & **Wright, L.** (2022). *Comments responding to US copyright office notice of inquiry docket no. 2021-10*. <https://osf.io/498ja/>

Matias, J. N., & **Wright, L.** (2022). *Innovation & governance of adaptive AI with community science* Submission to the U.S. Office of Science and Technology Policy Research and Development Strategic Plan.

SELECTED MEDIA AND BLOG CONTRIBUTIONS

Shulruff, T., **Wright, L.**, & Lazarus, J. (2025, July 25). *Online safety depends on a growing trust and safety vendor ecosystem* | *TechPolicy.press* [Tech policy press]. Retrieved August 2, 2025, from <https://techpolicy.press/online-safety-depends-on-a-growing-trust-and-safety-vendor-ecosystem>

Wright, L. (2019, June 13). *What speech police by David Kaye can teach us about YouTube's latest scandal* [Dangerous speech project]. Retrieved August 2, 2025, from <https://www.dangerousspeech.org/libraries/what-speech-police-by-david-kaye-can-teach-us-about-youtubes-latest-scandal>

Wright, L. (2017a, March 3). *Google's new 'toxicity' detecting software signals progress in online speech classifiers* [Dangerous speech project]. Retrieved August 2, 2025, from <https://www.dangerousspeech.org/libraries/googles-new-toxicity-detecting-software-signals-progress-in-online-speech-classifiers>

Wright, L. (2017b, November 10). *Tech can't solve the internet's worst problems—but you can* [Quartz] [Section: Tech & Innovation]. Retrieved August 2, 2025, from <https://qz.com/1125563/tech-cant-solve-the-internets-worst-problems-but-you-can>

Wright, L., Karsten, J., & West, D. M. (2016, April 19). *A brief history of u.s. encryption policy* [Brookings institution]. Retrieved August 2, 2025, from <https://www.brookings.edu/articles/a-brief-history-of-u-s-encryption-policy/>

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2023	COMPASS Fellow, National Telecommunications and Information Administration, Department of Commerce
2020–	Graduate Research Assistant, Citizens and Technology Lab, Cornell University
2019–2020	Researcher, Global Disinformation Index
2019	Research Consultant, Civic Signals Project, New America Foundation
2018–2019	Graduate Research Assistant, Offensive Internet Project, Oxford Internet Institute
2016–2017	Researcher, Dangerous Speech Project
2016	Research Intern, Center for Technology Innovation, Brookings Institution
2015	Elections Research Assistant, Change.org
2014	National Security and Human Rights Intern, Government Accountability Project

AWARDS AND GRANTS

2025	Finalist - NSF Law and Science Dissertation Grant
2024	Recipient - Cornell Graduate School Research Travel Grant
2024	Recipient - Cornell Qualitative and Interpretive Research Institute Research Grant
2020	Cornell Fellowship (one year of funding)
2016	Inducted into <i>Phi Beta Kappa</i>

TEACHING

Spring 2026	Trust and Safety in Online Platforms, Cornell University, Teaching Assistant and Co-Designer
Fall 2023	Communication and Technology, Cornell University, Teaching Assistant
Fall 2022	Research Methods in Communication Studies, Cornell University, Sections Instructor
Fall 2021	Oral Communication, Cornell University, Sections Instructor
Spring 2021	New Media and Society, Cornell University, Teaching Assistant
Fall 2020	Media Communication, Cornell University, Teaching Assistant
Spring 2017, 2018, 2019	The Idea of the Internet, Harvard University, Teaching Assistant
Spring 2016, Fall 2015	Laboratory in Leadership Development II, American University, Undergraduate Teaching Assistant
Fall 2015	Individual Freedom vs Authority, American University, Undergraduate Teaching Assistant
Spring 2014, Fall 2013	Laboratory in Leadership Development I, American University, Undergraduate Teaching Assistant

SERVICE

	Reviewer, Information, Communication, and Society
	Reviewer, New Media and Society
	Reviewer, Journal of Social Computing
	Reviewer, International Communication Association
	Reviewer, Association of Internet Researchers
	Reviewer, ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency
2022–2023	Treasurer, Cornell Communication Graduate Student Association

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

International Communication Association

Association of Internet Researchers

Association for Computing Machinery

Coalition for Independent Technology Research

Graduate Affiliate, UNC Center for Information, Technology, and Public Life